

Step 6/HM: Hiring team to complete feedback in Greenhouse

Once each step in the interview plan is completed, the interview team will submit feedback via the designated scorecard in Greenhouse within 1 business day of their interviews. Each scorecard will include the following required sections:

- Key Take-aways: This is an area to summarize your overall experience.
- Pros: This is an area to capture alignment on role responsibilities, competency alignments and much more!
- Cons: This is an area to capture opportunities, areas of improvement and/or specific feedback that would be useful to provide the candidate if a decision was made to not move forward with that candidate.

If you have any questions or experience any issues accessing your scorecard, please contact your Recruiter of the CES team.

Step 7/HM: Complete references

Once the recruiter/CES has notified the hiring manager of the references sent by the candidate, the hiring manager will complete references to establish the candidate's strengths and opportunities, to set them up for success once joining GitLab.

These reference checks will be performed in accordance with the applicable law of the jurisdiction. Where applicable, a reference check can also be used in the final decision for making an offer. The reference check is not the sole factor for a decision to hire or not hire a candidate. However, in conjunction with the interview scores and the interview team feedback, all of these factors go into the hiring manager decision.

At least 2 references must be completed and documented in Greenhouse (one of them must be a manager or supervisor unless this reference only exists at their current company), before moving to offer with the candidate, unless requirements set out by local law differ. If a manager receives conflicting or inconsistent feedback from the 2 references, the manager should complete a 3rd reference to determine if there is any validity to the feedback received.

Hiring managers are expected to contact references by call or by email. Some managers send the reference a brief email stating the purpose of the call and including a Calendly link so that the reference can select a convenient time. You can add a template to your Greenhouse account for quick use. Some managers also ask the candidate to reach out to their references to expect the email from the manager (as sometimes the email is ignored if the recipient is not expecting it).

For Engineering: Before extending an offer, one reference (from either a manager - preference or peer) must be completed and documented in Greenhouse by the Recruiter. After reviewing the initial reference, the Hiring Manager can either proceed with the offer or contact additional references themselves to gather more information about the candidate.

In Greenhouse: Configure (the gear on the top right) - Email Templates - My Templates - New. Be sure to create the template as a Team Email under the Type field. If you create the email

template with tokens please check the tokens were added correctly upon the first use.

After creating the email template you can send to the references. Because there is not a bcc option you should send individual emails to each reference. From the Candidate's profile: Tools (bottom right on the page view) - Email the Team - Choose a template (drop-down) - (select the name of the template you created) - Uncheck "Add a link to the candidate's profile" - Send Email.

Why Hiring Managers Should Check References

Hiring managers check references:

- To ensure we are hiring the right candidate.
- To understand under what circumstances this candidate thrives vs. what circumstances frustrates them.
 - As the hiring manager, you will be the closest to the GitLab team-member and benefit most from learning about them.
- To build your network.
 - As a hiring manager, you need to build a network for great talent. Each reference you talk to can be a part of that network.
- To use the opportunity to spread the GitLab story. We could spark new customers and new GitLab team-members.

All GitLab hiring managers should be making the best effort to complete and conduct the reference checks for their candidate.

Reference Check Questions

When a candidate passes the initial screening and first rounds of interviews, but before they advance to meet with senior leadership, the talent acquisition team will reach out to the candidate to collect their references' details. Once the talent acquisition team receives the references' details, they will inform the hiring manager, who should reach out and contact the references provided. If it is not possible to schedule a call via phone, a Hangouts or Zoom meeting can also be arranged if it's convenient. If that is not possible, an email can be sent with the following questions:

- Can you briefly describe your working relationship with them?
- What are they like to work with?
- What can they improve upon?
- What advice would you give their next hiring manager?
- Would you rehire this person?
- If we hired this person, would that make you more likely to work at GitLab, even if you don't know what we do?

You can also elaborate further and ask follow up questions if the opportunity arises. The hiring team will be adding engineering questions into Greenhouse so that all engineering hiring managers have access to the same ones. Additionally, the hiring team will work with each function to identify any other specific questions hiring managers would like to add to Greenhouse for their team.

You should not ask any questions about the person's race, gender, sexual preference, disabilities or health, political affiliations, religion, or family (children). Example questions not to ask:

- Who watches their children while they are at work?
- What types of groups does the candidate belong to that are not work related?

Use our guide to scoring to help select the vote you choose when submitting a scorecard for each reference check.

Reference Check Review

All reference check feedback should be entered into Greenhouse using the Reference Checks scorecard. To add this information, go to the candidate's profile, make sure they are in the "Reference Checks" stage, and click "Collect Feedback".

It is the hiring manager's responsibility to do the reference checks, but the hiring team may also provide assistance and guidance. You can also refer to these guidelines.

If References Don't Provide Full References

Increasingly, organizations have a company policy that prevents their employees from providing references; instead, they are only able to verify employment, including dates of employment and title. Do not judge a candidate because his or her former employer has this policy: it does not mean the candidate was not successful. Instead, go back to the candidate to get the name and contact information for an alternative reference.

Internal References

The talent acquisition team may also ask candidates if they've worked with anyone in the past who currently works at GitLab or knows someone at GitLab that we could talk to.

If a GitLab team member provides a positive or negative feedback on a candidate, they should provide specific details of their experience and relationship with the candidate to enable the hiring manager to make an informed decision.

Backchannel References

At no time should a backchannel reference be completed. A backchannel reference is defined as reaching out to someone in a candidate's network (professional or personal), to gather feedback about the candidate without their consent or knowledge. Doing backchannel reference checks is counter to GitLab's value of transparency. It may also have unintended, negative consequences for the person being backchanneled.

SECTION: hiring/talent-acquisition-framework/internal-hiring-process.md

Team Member Responsibilities

- Meet with your current manager to discuss the internal opportunity you'd like to pursue prior to submitting your application.
- Ensure you have met your department specific eligibility requirements:
 - Guidelines for performance eligibility:
 - Team members who are assessed at a Performing or Exceeding Performance level during Talent Assessment are eligible to be considered for another role
 - Team members whose Performance is assessed as Developing or are actively undergoing written performance management, may not be eligible. These situations require manager and/or PBP approval to proceed.
 - Team members that have not had a Talent Assessment require manager and/or PBP approval to proceed
 - Time in role eligibility will be 6 months in current role. Exceptions to this:
 - Job Family specialty changes
 - Business Impact (revenue-dependencies, interim role to perm)
 - Business driven transfers (example of realignments)
 - SDR 12 months in role
- Important things to consider when applying:
 1. Ensure the opportunity aligns with your career goals here at GitLab
 1. We encourage you to bring any questions around compensation and leveling to the recruiter and/or hiring manager for the open role you are interested in and applying for. Expect the recruiter to discuss the compensation bands with you during your first screening call.
 1. While you may apply to a role with a higher job grade and title, there may be situations (moving from one job family to another for example) where the higher job grade may not align with your current competencies and skillset that is required for the role. If the hiring team does choose to move forward with an offer, in these cases, it's likely a higher job grade and title will not be given.
- To apply, visit the internal job openings. If you are interested in keeping an eye on openings that are posted you can also join the newvacancy channel in Slack.
- For any questions you have about internal hiring or questions specific to your individual interview process you can either:
 - Create an issue in the hiring process repo.
 - If a Recruiter has reached out to you, please feel free to reach out directly to them on status updates of your specific process.

Recruiter Responsibilities

- Recruiter will post a job internally following the req creation process, and the transfer, promotion guidelines.
- Recruiters will set up notifications for internal applications, to ensure they are notified when internal candidates apply to the role
- Once the Recruiter receives an internal team members application, they will proceed with the following:
 - Review the application as you would with an external candidate and determine if they are qualified for the role. If they are not qualified, please ensure you communicate the decision via email (or slack) and provide clear feedback as to why they are not qualified, and add the hiring manager so they are looped in and can add additional feedback if appropriate.
 - Ensure the internal team members GitLab email is associated with their application. If it is not, then update it as such and notify the team member of the change in email address to ensure all the communication throughout the interview process is directed here.
 - If the internal candidate is considered qualified for the role, reach out to People Connect

by submitting a request via HelpLab.

- Once you have received a reply on eligibility please continue with the steps below
- If they have additional questions, they may reach out to the team member's current PBP.
- For promotions through the internal mobility process (upward movement from one job grade to another), tag the department specific People Business Partner in the notes section of Greenhouse to ensure they are aligned before moving forward with the offer. Additionally, confirm that the offer has been approved by the skip-level leader of the new role.
- Once the Recruiter has confirmed the eligibility status via HelpLab (and the team member is confirmed eligible) the Recruiter will reach out to the team member to introduce themselves and set expectations around the internal hiring process. This includes ensuring they have notified their current manager.
- If a team member is not eligible, the Recruiter will send the appropriate decline email template.
- The recruiter will also review the team member's current compensation (found in Workday) to ensure they are in line with the salary range and budget for the role.
- If a team member's current compensation exceeds the budget and/or salary range for the role (due to level or different job family), the recruiter will inform the team member of a potential change to their compensation before completing any team interviews.
- Recruiter will then continue the process as described in the Talent Acquisition Process Framework for all candidates. Recruiter will use identified templates in Greenhouse to communicate with candidates, current managers and hiring managers throughout the internal hiring process.
- Once it is confirmed that the internal candidate is moving to the offer stage, the Recruiter will connect the team member's current manager and potential new manager via Slack to:
 - Give formal notice that an offer is being created for the team member.
 - At the same time you should tag the relevant People Business Partner (both the departing and receiving PBP) in a note on Greenhouse so they are notified, can track the internal move and take any necessary action.
 - Facilitate a discussion around a transition date that works for both parties. Please note that TA's involvement is to facilitate this conversation and is not the decision maker. Ultimately, a transition date is something that should be agreed upon between a current manager and hiring manager. A finalized start date will be needed as TA submits an offer for approvals.
- Some suggestions for transition timelines include:
 - Aiming for between 4-6 weeks for an official transition date to ensure the team with the backfill has lead time on filling the position
 - A one month 50/50 split between teams to ease into a full time transition. For any moves from Sales Development, please be aware the team requests a 45 day transition period from the date of a verbal offer
- Please note the following about this process:
 - TA will only start an official backfill once the role has been approved via the Backfill Approval process
 - It is the Team Member's responsibility to meet with their current manager to discuss the internal opportunity they'd like to pursue prior to submitting their application. Offers at the end of an internal interview process should not come as a surprise to current managers.
 - TA will not discuss any compensation changes with the team member's current manager.
 - TA will not provide updates on interview feedback or progress to a team member's current manager. This should be discussed between managers and team members during 1:1s.
 - Should the Recruiter not have access to a team member's compensation (due to moving Divisions), you should
 - Reach out to People Connect by submitting a request through HelpLab using the Internal

Movement case template. In your request details please include that you the candidate has been selected to move forward and that you require their current compensation details. People Connect will only confirm the salary details and any confirmation on equity would need to be verified by the Total Rewards team separately.

- Within 48 hours, the People Connect team will respond and provide annual base compensation details to the Recruiter to utilize for the offer (in partnership with the hiring manager).

Template for the Recruiter's slack message

Hi XX and XX,

As you are both aware, XXX has been interviewing for the XXX role and the team is ready to move forward with an offer! I wanted to connect you both as their current and future managers to cover a few items as we start the offer process:

- What transition date works best for the both of you? The GitLab standard recommendation is between 4-6 weeks (OR 45 days for Sales Development). Please see our handbook page here for some suggestions on transition timelines.
- Please discuss any outstanding items that may require XX to stay in their current role longer than 6 weeks as we want to ensure they'll be able to have a smooth transition between roles.
- I'd recommend connecting live if you can, but if not, async works and we can use this channel. If you do connect live, please confirm with me once you've done so and agreed on a start date. Once I have that information, I will proceed with the formal offer approvals. Once they accept the offer (and sign the Job Change Letter), we will be able to move forward with their backfill process. Thanks!
- If the hiring team would like to move forward with an offer, the Recruiter will access the team members current compensation in Workday to create the offer (in partnership with the hiring manager). Any confirmation on equity would need to be verified by the Total Rewards team separately.
- Once an internal candidate verbally accepts an offer, the Recruiter will notify CES to get the Job Change Letter (JCL) to the team member.

CES Responsibilities

- When scheduling internal team members during the internal hiring process, use the team member's Google calendar. This allows for a consistent and efficient scheduling process. Internal candidates are notified to:
 - Block off any times on their calendar when they would prefer not to interview.
 - Have working hours visible on their internal Google Calendar
- Please follow the scheduling process for executive scheduling
- Recruiters will notify CES via Greenhouse once a Job Change Letter (JCL) is ready to be sent.

People Connect Responsibilities

- People Connect will handle all eligibility checks for team members applying for an internal opportunity.
 - For eligibility checks for candidates on the People Connect team please reach out directly to the Manager of the People Connect team.
- Engage People Connect by submitting a request via HelpLab. People Connect will notify the

Recruiter that the eligibility check is completed by replying to the request submitted via HelpLab. Ensure you have met your department specific eligibility requirements:

- Guidelines for performance eligibility:
 - Team members who are assessed at a Performing or Exceeding Performance level during Talent Assessment are eligible to be considered for another role
 - Team members whose Performance is assessed as Developing or are actively undergoing written performance management, may not be eligible. These situations require manager and/or PBP approval to proceed.
 - Team members that have not had a Talent Assessment require manager and/or PBP approval to proceed
 - Time in role eligibility will be 6 months in current role. Exceptions to this:
 - Job Family specialty changes
 - Business Impact (revenue-dependencies, interim role to perm)
 - Business driven transfers (example of realignments)
 - SDR 12 months in role
 - SDR/BDR Team Lead 3 months in role
 - For any situations where further discussion may be needed, People Connect Leads will go to the department specific PBP.
 - At the offer stage, should the Recruiter not have access to compensation data (due to a candidate moving Divisions for example), they will submit a request via HelpLab to attain current compensation information:
 - People Connect checks Workday for current team member base compensation.
 - People Connect will then provide annual base compensation details in the HelpLab request.
- The Recruiter can then utilize this information while putting an offer together (in partnership with the hiring manager).

Current Manager Responsibilities

- Once your team member has notified you that they have applied for an internal opportunity (this should happen at the application stage) make sure to check in with them during 1:1s to see how their interviews are progressing.
- If your team member moves to the offer stage, the Recruiter will connect you with the hiring manager via Slack. Please follow the steps outlined by the Recruiter once you receive that confirmation. Until you receive that Slack from TA, the offer is not confirmed.
- Once the transition date is agreed upon, the current manager is responsible for notifying their leadership and to follow the steps outlined in the Backfill Approval process handbook page
- If the team member is not selected for the new role, the current manager should meet with the team member to discuss ongoing career development in their current role.

Hiring Manager Responsibilities

- Hiring Managers will be notified by Recruiter when an internal team member has applied and has completed the necessary eligibility checks as mentioned above, and they will follow the process outlined in the Talent Acquisition Process Framework for all candidates.
- If a team member moves to offer, the Recruiter will connect the Hiring Manager with the team member's current manager. Please follow the steps outlined by the Recruiter in their message via Slack (details above).
- Hiring Manager will be provided the candidates compensation expectations from the Recruiter. It is up to the Hiring Manager, in partnership with the Recruiter, to propose a compensation

aligned with budget, candidate expectations, and internal pay equality.

- If internal candidates need to be declined post interviews, it is required that the hiring manager connect with the team member via Zoom to inform them of the decision and provide constructive feedback (an outline providing feedback can be found below).

Delivering feedback to declined candidates

At any stage a team member needs to be declined, it is up to the Recruiter and Hiring Manager to connect to determine the best approach to ensure the appropriate feedback is given by the hiring manager. It is important to deliver transparent and honest feedback to the candidate while remaining constructive and focusing on growth.

If the candidate has made it to the hiring manager screen or beyond, hiring managers can consider this approach:

- Condense the themes from all of the scorecards so that there is a high level, but anonymous summary of what they did well in the interview, and any opportunities for improvement
- Document your key takeaway as a hiring manager in terms of how this candidate does not have the right competencies for the position
- Document your key takeaways on what the candidate did well and should continue doing, along with improving other areas to be ready in the future
- Provide actionable, concrete steps to work on those areas
- Sync with the candidate to review these topics in a synchronous meeting

A guideline template to prepare for this conversation might look like the following:

What went well:

- Has good examples of making improvements to the area they were interviewing for in the past

Opportunities for improvement:

- In general if experience was missing (such as XYZ) when asked a question, they were not able to answer it based on any lessons/training they have taken in preparation for this role

Key Takeaways (to be delivered synchronously):

- They understand the day-to-day responsibilities of this role in terms of (these job requirements), but are not yet prepared for what this looks like long-term around (these other job requirements and challenges they may face). They may be coachable in these areas and have an exceptional history with GitLab, however this position will be demanding on time which may not allow the candidate to get enough support in the role. I would recommend:
 - Specific actions this candidate can take to get more experience at GitLab

If you are not sure what actions they can be taking to be more qualified for your position, you may reference your role's job requirements and/or the Job Framework for inspiration defining concrete actions.

Internal Hiring Process Survey

- A survey will be sent out to all team members that have made it through to the team interview stage.
- This survey will measure:
 - Expectations set
 - Recruiter interaction
 - Interviewer experience
 - Timely experience
 - Scheduling
 - Feedback (for declined candidates)
 - Overall experience rating
- Talent Acquisition's goals for this survey will be determined after the base survey data is captured.

SECTION: hiring/talent-acquisition-framework/offer-process.md

There are a series of steps that are taken when preparing a job offer at GitLab to ensure there is consistency and fairness in our hiring process.

These steps outline all of the major stages that Recruiters follow in our job offer process.

Debrief Stage

Purpose: The purpose of the 'debrief' stage is to drive towards a hire/no hire decision at the end of our interview process. Once all scorecards are submitted and interviews are complete, recruiter is to move candidate to this stage within Greenhouse

R&D Process Specifics

There are two specialized notes for the Engineering, Product and Security teams as a part of this process to ensure we are further optimizing for speed and asynchronous decision making given the global distribution of our interview teams.

1. When a candidate is moved to the 'debrief' stage (also known as the 'justification stage') recruiter is to kick off reference checks.

1. Recruiter to review scorecards and ensure candidate is ready for review and all Engineering Hiring Practices have been met. Once confirmed, recruiter tags hiring manager in candidate profile to initiate 'justification'.

1. Once a 'hire' decision has been made, there is an additional step - the justification. The justification is intended to serve as an asynchronous method to articulate the hiring decision as well as flesh out any nuances in the decision not captured in scorecards. Justifications are reviewed by offer approvers farther along in the process. A hiring manager will need to answer the following questions in the candidate's profile within Greenhouse prior to an offer preparation:

Justification Questions:

- In what specific way(s) does this candidate make the team better?
- What flags were raised during the interview process? Include any past rejections, thumbs-down

ratings, or hesitancy from previous interview scorecards (but not resume reviews), as well as your reasons for being comfortable moving forward despite interviewer recommendation.

- How do we intend on setting this candidate up for success?
- Engineering specific: Does the candidate meet a simple majority of nice-to-have requirements (5 of 9) for the specific role? (please add them to the appropriate scorecard section)

Reference Check Stage

Once a hiring decision has been reached (note: for all teams outside of R&D) the recruiter is to start the reference check process. For R&D offers, this process is run in tandem with the 'debrief' stage (see above section).

We require references for all external candidates at offer via sending a Reference Check Form in Greenhouse. To use this form:

1. Update notifications on the job for reference check. Navigate to 'Job Setup', select 'Forms' and edit the individual reference form. Add hiring manager to notification so they can initiate the calls once references have been submitted.

1. Click the 'send' button on the location-specific form attached to the Greenhouse reference check stage.

1. Once references are submitted, your Hiring Manager will be responsible for completing reference checks.

The Reference Check Form will request references' contact details as well as candidate details that will help with a future offer. You can view completed forms in the "Application" tab.

- The address, preferred first name/nickname, preferred last name, and PIAA details will auto-populate into the candidates' details. Any other fields, including their legal name, will not transfer outside of the form and need to be added manually. If a candidate requests changes to their legal name, you will need to do that manually. As a reminder, middle names are not required as part of legal names.

- Fields that are entered in offers, such as BSN and Date of Birth for the Netherlands, should be added during the Offer stage by the Recruiter.

- CES will be responsible for 3-4 fields in the Reference Check form, depending on location. These include PIAA, Outside Work, TMRG calls, and NYC background check fields. CES instructions can be found [here](#).

Please note that these forms, just like an Offer in Greenhouse, are connected to the specific job you request them for. You cannot transfer forms to another job, so be sure you're hiring into that req before sending a form. If you transfer the candidate, the form will not transfer. If no forms are listed, please contact the Enablement team.

For more information about Reference Checks from a Hiring Manager perspective, [click here](#).

Background Check and Offer Stage

After the reference check stage is completed with positive references, candidate is moved to the Background Check and Offer stage

Offer Fields

A description on what to input into each Offer field in Greenhouse can be found below.

{{% details summary="Offer Fields and How to Use Them" %}}

- Opening: If you have multiple openings, you are typically choosing the one that started the earliest. You can check the approvals tab to confirm this, but you should also be able to tell based on the smallest opening number. Choosing the earliest opening helps ensure an accurate Time to Fill.
- Start date: New hires start on Monday, with exceptions made for public holidays for a new hires' location, Family & Friends Day, and other designated no start dates as chosen by People Connect. Additionally, internal hires with salary changes start on the 1st or 16th only (regardless of the day of the week), and those in Sales can only start on the 1st.
- Job Title: It's important that we use the correct title, which should not include a specialty. People Managers have "Manager, " before the rest of their title, whereas individual contributors will have the title followed by Manager. Total Rewards will review this title to ensure it matches with those in Workday. In some cases, such as Area Sales Manager, industry standards indicate that our expected conventions will not work and exceptions are made.
- Level of Role: Anything Director+ is considered a "Leader"
- Division: This field is synched with Workday and will update as new divisions are created.
- Department: This field is synched with Workday and will update as new divisions are created.
- Employment Type: Select either 'full time' or 'intern' pending role type.
- Employment Status: Select non-exempt for all roles with hourly wages which are paid overtime. For salaried, non-overtime eligible roles, select exempt. This information can be found in the Interlock sheet for confirmation.
- Hiring Manager/Hiring Manager Title: Please provide a full title and preferred name for your hiring manager as seen in Workday.
- Candidate City: Choose the actual city where the candidate is located, not their locality.
- State/Province: This field is synched with Workday and is only applicable to the US and Canada.
- Candidate Country: This field is synched with Workday. If the candidate is currently living in a different country than where their contract is stating (ie they currently live in Germany and are going to be working in Netherlands), please choose the place they will be working, but let CES know so they can order a background check for the place where they are currently working. Please note that Northern Ireland is part of the United Kingdom, so ask Enablement if you're unsure of what country to list.
- Locality: Use this link to help you determine your locality. More details on how to select a specific city can be found here.
- Comp Calc Link: Include a link to the comp calc that you used to determine salary, or outside documentation. If you had an exception, please include a link to that documentation here.
- Did this offer require a comp exception? In this field, you can single or multi-select the following options: No comp exception required, Yes - Base, Yes - Equity, Yes - Bonus and/or Yes - Sign-On.
- Compensation Package: Tell us what type of offer this is---whether it has a bonus or signing bonus included. This field is used to populate information within the contract itself, so it's important that you select the correct option.
- Currency and Annual Salary: Candidates are paid in local currency. Click here for a current list of any locations where exceptions can be made if a candidate asks. Annual and monthly salaries should be rounded up or down to the nearest whole currency unit and should always end with a zero (e.g., "50,110.00" or "23,500.00"). Hourly rates should be rounded to the nearest quarter-currency unit (e.g., 11.25/hr.).

- Base Salary and Equity Compa-Ratio: These mandatory fields are used to report back to the business (except when recording equity compa-ratio for internal offers). Please use the format 0.00 meaning an offer at 85% of median would be inputted as 0.85.
 - Are they paid yearly or hourly?: If the salary is an annual salary, rather than an hourly rate, choose yearly.
 - Variable Bonus Type: Choosing this field will add a designated paragraph to your candidate's contract that explains how a commission or director bonus works.
 - Variable bonus frequency: This details whether the variable bonus shown is per year, not how it is paid out. All bonus information is calculated per year.
 - Bonus Currency & Amount: This is calculated per year, in the same currency as their salary.
 - Signing Currency & Amount: This is a one-time payment in the same currency as their salary.
 - Bonus/Variable Percent: This is a bonus field that specifies what percent of the total salary is bonus. This field will not be used in contracts and is only used for Workday.
 - References Checked: This verifies for record whether you have already completed references, or if you've told the candidate that the offer is contingent on positive references as they're still in progress.
 - Family Relationship: Use this field to let CES know if there's a family relationship that will require a Family Member Acknowledgement form.
 - Signatory Name & Signatory Title: See this chart for a list of signatories per country.
 - Clearances: If you will be sending a Federal contract, please use these fields to designate if clearances are required in order to complete the job, and what bonus would be given if that is the case.
 - End Date: Use for Inc (USA) contractors and interns only.
 - Entity: This is a great place to see which entities are currently associated with different countries. If your candidate has a position that includes "Federal" or PubSec" in the title, or you believe they'll be working in government contracts, please discuss with your Hiring Manager if they belong in the Federal entity. If you're not sure, discuss with Legal before CES sends a contract. If the candidate is internal and is moving from a different entity to Federal, or from Federal to a different entity, please send a note to CES that the candidate requires a full contract rather than an LOA.
 - Total Rewards: Skip these fields, Total Rewards will add them during their approval stage.
 - Candidate BSN: These fields are for Netherlands candidates only, and answers can be found in your completed Reference Check form.
 - Nationality & Country of Citizenship: Please fill these out for any PEO contracts. The answer will be in your completed Reference Check form.
 - Indefinite or Fixed Contract: Netherlands hires will receive a fixed contract for their first year, as will any contractors or interns. Other than these, you can select "no" or leave this field blank.
- {{% /details %}}

Note: The Reference Check Form does not automatically update a candidates' legal name, so that will need to be updated manually in the Details tab.

Internal Candidates: recruiter is to wait until after offer has been presented, but before the candidate is marked as hired, to merge the applicants' profiles. All other candidates should have profiles merged as early as possible. Please visit the Enablement handbook page for instructions.

Constructing an Offer:

Talent Acquisition partners with hiring managers in order to advise on best practice in constructing a total compensation package (the offer). Offers are constructed of base pay, bonus (when applicable) and equity. Base pay is based off of proficiency and performance, and recruiters will advise to take the following into account when positioning a candidate within range for the job (also known as compensation-ratio):

- 1. salary range
- 1. candidate interview performance (competency)
- 1. job information
- 1. team member parity

Special Considerations

1. Relocations need to be called out in Compensation Details should include originating location and salary, as well as the new location and new salary details to ensure it is communicated as part of the approval and the correct entity is selected. Ensure the People Connect team is informed about any known relocations within the first 90 days of employment. Recruiters should also communicate if the candidate is moving between countries, because CES will need to request a background check in the country where they are currently living. The CES will initiate the background check during the verbal offer stage.

1. Internal Candidates need to include inputs in the 'Approval Notes' section. Recruiter to include candidate's current level and position, as well as their compensation package. If the comp has a variable component, please include base, on target earnings (OTE), and split in this section.

Additional Process for Engineering

Recruiters advise and partner with hiring manager to construct compensation package for candidates. Once details are confirmed, there are a few additional steps specifically for Engineering offers starting in FY25 Q3 as follows:

1. For any offer with a compa-ratio above 0.80, flag this to the TA Manager or Director. The TA Manager/Director will then seek VP approval via Slack for all such cases. If an offer exceeds 0.85 compa-ratio, you must first complete the Exception Form and submit it to the TA Manager/Director, who will then obtain approval from the corresponding VP and CTO. Once approved, recruiter to move through next steps - offer approval process.

- When creating the offer in Greenhouse, add a link to the 0.85+ VP Approval Template in the Comp Calc Link & Additional Context section

1. Recruiter to add compa-ratio information in Pod Squad and the offer form

1. For any offers at or below 0.80 compa-ratio, recruiter to move through next steps - offer approval process.

Offer Approval Process

For all offers within range (ie: no exceptions) they will route through the following approval path:

- 1. Total Rewards
- 1. FP&A Partner
- 1. Business Leader (department head/ VP)

Total Rewards reviews:

- Compensation in range
- Ensure the bonus percentage, if applicable, matches bonus percent amount. For bonus/commission, this will be a percent of OTE. For Director level bonus, this will be a percent of base.
- Audit stock options, department, division, etc.
- Add entity, job code, job grade, sales geo differential
- Ensure the title is added to Workday.

FP&A reviews:

- Compensation package to budget

Common approval challenges:

- Out of Office: If the offer is stuck in the approvals chain because someone is out of office, the Recruiter to proactively reach out to the approver's manager about an appropriate temporary adjustment. Recruiter to work with Enablement team to update approval path.
- Incorrect Offer Approver: Recruiter to work with Enablement team to correct.

Counter offer details:

Information in the offer package for counter offers should include the following in the "Approval Notes" section:

- New offer:
- Original offer:
- Justification for adjustment:

Verbal Job Offer

Once the offer is fully approved in Greenhouse, an offer will be verbalized to the candidate by the Recruiter.

Please note: Japan offers are contingent on a cleared background check. Recruiter is to let the candidate know that they would like to make an offer, but it is contingent upon their background checking coming back clear.

Offer details usually include:

- Start Date - ensure that the candidates start date is not a no-start date (unless needed for legal reasons) and is at least 10 business days from offer acceptance. For PEOs, partner with CES to build in appropriate leadtime.
- Job Title
- Salary
- General and specific benefits
- Contract type and employment type
- Onboarding process
- Asynchronous communication

- Stock options
- Unlimited paid-time-off
- Incentives
- Office equipment/reimbursements
- Configuring your new laptop
- Employment Assistance Program

Sending the Employment Contract/Offer Letter

Once a verbal offer is made to a candidate...

1. Recruiter will notify @ces to send a contract to the candidate via Greenhouse email. The Talent Acquisition team will sometimes refer to an Offer Letter and Employment Contract interchangeably, because they are called Offer Letters in the US and Employment Contracts outside of the US.
1. Any special circumstances regarding relocation communicated in the notification to CES to ensure it is added to the contract.
1. Once a candidate signs a contract, the CES will send welcome email with instructions on hardware ordering and next steps.

Declined Offers

Offer acceptance rates are a key metric for Talent Acquisition, and unfortunately, offer declines will happen. In order to ensure we are measuring our offer acceptance rate appropriately, recruiters need to move candidates within Greenhouse at the appropriate times.

1. When a decision has been made at debrief to move forward with an offer, candidate is moved to Offer and Background Check stage. If candidate declines a verbal or written offer, this will then be caught in our offer acceptance rate.
1. Recruiter notifies Finance Business Partner via the candidates notes section in GH that the candidate has declined the offer
1. FP&A will make appropriate changes in Adaptive
1. If contract has been generated, recruiter notifies CES via the candidate notes section in GH that the candidate has declined offer and the contract needs to be voided. CES will then follow their own decline process.
1. Recruiter to then disposition the candidate with the appropriate offer decline reasoning so we can measure/monitor rationale for declined offers and partner cross functionally around themes as they present. Please ensure you add relevant notes about why the candidate rejected our offer in the 'Rejection Notes' section. Any details about compensation and numbers should be added as a private note.

Hired

Accepted Offers After the employment contract has been signed by both a GitLab signatory and the candidate:

1. Recruiter to disposition all remaining candidates on position within 24 hours of offer acceptance. Recruiter to manage any active candidates in pipeline appropriately.
1. CES will send a welcome email and mark the candidate as Hired in Greenhouse.
1. Once the candidate has been marked as Hired, this will trigger a sync with Workday and

initiate the pre-onboarding process with the People Connect team.

SECTION: hiring/talent-acquisition-framework/req-creation.md

Prior to starting the req creation process, a Hiring Manager should follow the steps outlined to create a Job Family or create a MR to edit any relevant Job Family information as needed. For questions specific to Hiring Plans or how to go about making such changes, please refer to the Finance section of the handbook.

Process Overview

1. Requisition Release (requisition details from FP&A load into dept LIVE Interlock sheets)
1. Backfill Approval (backfill requisitions only)
1. Hiring Manager create/review Job Family
1. Open requisition in Greenhouse
1. Formal approval to open role
1. Run kick-off (aka Intake) with Hiring Manager

Requisition Release

There are three creation types for new requisitions: Annual Planned Headcount, Rolling List of Ask (RLoA) Incremental Headcount and Backfills. Annual Planned Headcount is released at the beginning of each fiscal year. RLoA Incremental Headcount is released each quarter for the following quarter (ie: Q2 cycle will release Q3 headcount). Backfills are opened with attrition throughout the year.

How is headcount communicated:

1. Annual Planned headcount: Communicated by FP&A partners to TA, PBPs and business leadership at the beginning of each fiscal year.
1. RLoA headcount: Communicated by FP&A partners to TA, PBPs and business leadership upon approval by e-group (typically at the beginning of each fiscal quarter).
1. Backfills: Upon a resignation, hiring managers are to submit official notice to Workday to trigger alignment about backfill req (see below).

All headcount, once funded and released, will show up in department LIVE Interlock Reports (linked below). The Talent Acquisition leadership will then allocate a recruiter to the role based off of capacity and domain alignment. The recruiter is the main driver for moving the hiring process forward at a reasonable pace and will partner with the hiring manager on creating a requisition.

If there is not a current job family, the recruiter is to guide the hiring manager to proceed to create or review the Job Family. Hiring Managers should not wait on an approved requisition to begin this step.

Backfill Approvals

All backfill roles will work through an approval process before moving to the next step of the

recruiting process.

To open a backfill:

1. The Manager of a departing team member enters attrition in Workday via the off-boarding process.
1. Each week, by noon (PST) Monday, Corporate FP&A downloads the data from Adaptive and refreshes the confidential LIVE Headcount lists shared with TA, FP&A, and relevant leaders
 1. By the end of the day (PST) Monday, Corporate notifies FP&A partners of targeted conversations with E-Group during the week.
 1. By the end of the day (PST) Wednesday, divisional FP&A teams align with E-Group and PBPs to review all new backfill roles and determine the appropriate action for each.
 1. If no decisions are made, FP&A will mark backfill as paused
 1. If decisions are made, FP&A will ensure Position IDs and GHPIDs are processed and shared with TA by the end of the day on Wednesday.
 - For roles being repurposed: the business leader owns communication to the team to discuss the rationale and drive clarity. PBP/Strategy team partners on reallocation decisions.
 1. Taking the E-Group leader's decisions, each divisional Recruiting Leader will allocate the role to the appropriate recruiter.
 1. Once the role is approved/the decision has been reached and the role is allocated, the Recruiting partner will set up a kickoff strategy call with the hiring manager and will create a position in Greenhouse for approval to move to the next step of the process.
 1. By the end of the day (PST) Thursday, the FP&A update Adaptive
 1. FP&A includes their best estimates of the start dates of all planned personnel for the forecast period based on the input from Talent Acquisition in the headcount forecast templates. This reflects a 50/50 ·most realistic· view of headcount expenses/timing and is part of the current Forecast Interlock process.

Create or Review the Job Family (DRI: Hiring Manager)

The Hiring Manager will review the position description in the /job-families folder and update it, if needed. If there is no existing job family, they should follow the steps to create a new job family. A compensation benchmark for the role should be set by working with the Compensation & Benefits team.

It is important to ensure this process is done early, because it takes time to go through approvals and Total Rewards will not approve a job opening without a matching job family.

Open Requisition in Greenhouse (DRI: Recruiter)

Terms you need to know

- Job: A job refers to the job title (ex: Customer Support Specialist). This will also be what appears on external job boards. In the case there are multiple positions open that are the same, and we only want to list once, we can have multiple openings (see next section) opened within one Job. Each job will have a unique identifier called a Requisition ID (example- 1001).
- Opening: A job can have multiple openings attached to it (ex: you are hiring 3 Customer Support Specialists. You would then have 1 Job and 3 openings against that job). A job can have multiple openings against it, but an opening can not be associated with multiple jobs. Each opening will have a unique identifier called an Opening ID (example- 1001-1, 1001-2, 1001-3).

- GHPiD: GHP ID is the link between Adaptive (what we use to track our operating plan) and Greenhouse (our ATS). A GHP ID has a one to one relationship with an Opening ID. It is the key interlock between our hiring plans and our Talent Acquisition activity. This is a custom field in Greenhouse and all GHPIDs are system-generated by FP&A (see FP&A section of the handbook)

Determining what type of job to open

There are a few options for what to open in Greenhouse.

- Open a new job
- Open an additional opening onto an existing job
 - If the job is currently open, recruiters can add an additional opening through the approvals page. It is vital that each opening is opened, associated with the correct GHPiD and documented in Greenhouse so reporting can tell us how many positions are open.
- Reopen an old job
 - We do not reopen old jobs.
- Evergreen job
 - An Evergreen Job is a requisition that is always open... more specifically, it is used when we have at least 3 openings for a particular job repeated each quarter. There is then one Evergreen job posted for internal, external and passive candidates. It is important that no candidate is hired to an Evergreen job, and instead is moved to an approved opening (aka - an opening with a single corresponding GHPiD).
- When should an Evergreen req be used?

TA Leadership will open EVG roles at the start of a fiscal year, with a quarterly review cadence, by leveraging the hiring plan and attrition assumptions. Typically, EVG postings will be utilized when there are multiple openings for a set of roles (3 or more) that have very similar technical qualifications and are expected to be hired on a regular basis (for example, Business Development Rep, AMER). These roles usually span multiple teams and hiring managers., but are all interviewed with the same process by the same interviewer 'pool'. Regular basis refers to consistent volume over a period of 3+ quarters.
- How do I open an evergreen req?

All evergreen reqs need to be approved by TALT (Jake Foster or Jess Dallmar) prior to opening.

If you are looking to open a job for pipeline reasons, because a Hiring Manager has requested that you work on a role that will be open in the future but has not been approved, instead of an EVG role use our Greenhouse CRM.

The Recruiter will:

1. The Recruiter will open a kick-off issue. This will happen simultaneously with the steps for opening the job in Greenhouse below.
1. Log in to Greenhouse and hover over the plus sign in the top right corner of their dashboard, and then click Create a Job.
1. Click on Start from a copy of an existing job. From there, select Any Status at the top bar, select Draft, and choose the template for the division. If you need a template created, please speak with a member of the Enablement team.

Once you've selected a template to copy, the first screen will ask for Basic Job Info.

1. The Internal Job Name is only viewable within Greenhouse, and the External Job Name is what appears on the jobs page. Enter in the requisition's title in these fields, including Specialty, if applicable. These two fields will almost always be the same.

1. Department is the department this role will fall under. Always choose a department and not a division (e.g. for a Security Engineer opening, choose Security within the Engineering division, and do not choose Engineering). If you are unsure of what department to choose, reach out to your FP&A partner.

1. If a requisition can be located anywhere GitLab hires, check Anywhere next to Office. If an opening is dedicated to a certain region or time zone, uncheck the Anywhere box and select any of the predetermined regions or time zones.

1. Click Generate IDs to create a requisition ID. You'll need this again when you set up your opening(s).

1. Under Job Family URL, ensure you are linking to the correct job family page. It is the Recruiter's responsibility to ensure that the job family has the specific job listed before submitting the requisition for approval. If the job family is currently in approvals, please contact Total Rewards to ensure you are clear before moving forward. If you skip this step and the job makes it to the offer stage, the process will stall during Total Rewards approval and will take significantly longer to get approved. It is OK if the job title in Greenhouse is not identical to the job family for posting purposes.

1. Under Employment Type, select your opening type - which unless there is an explicit exception, should be Full-Time. Contract refers to a true consultant, who works on short-term projects, and not someone in a country like the Netherlands who requires a one-year contract before indefinite. Talent Acquisition only supports Full Time Employee hiring at this time.

1. Most positions will not be marked confidential. If you have prior approval from Jess Dallmar, and Enablement, you can select Yes under Confidential?. Selecting Yes will ensure that the Enablement team specifically excludes any jobs with this selected from reports. It does not change access or permissions, so you will still need to evaluate those to remove anyone who should not see your job.

1. CA/CO/HI/NY/NJ/WA/DC/IL/MN Salary should be filled in if you believe you may list your position in the United States. If not, Recruiters can list 1-1 as the salary range as it's a required field. To find the salary range, utilize the comp calculator and search for Colorado (metro area = not applicable) for the minimum and California (metro area = San Francisco) for the maximum. This field is tied to your job post, so it's important that it's filled in correctly.

1. Fill in the Openings Section. Your opening ID is your req ID with -1, -2, etc following it. It is not the GHPID.

1. Enter the Target Start Date as listed on the GitLab Hiring Plan

1. Under Type choose if this is a Annual Plan, Backfill, Incremental or Intern. If you select Backfill, please enter the name of the teammate you are backfilling on the line below.

1. Annual Plan: Refers to any budgeted net new role included at the start of the fiscal year as part of the planned headcount. These roles will appear in the interlock sheet and are typically labeled as ·FYxx AOP· in the ·employee name· field.

1. Backfill: Refers to budgeted roles generated throughout the year due to a team member's departure. These will also be visible in the interlock sheet and labeled as backfill in the ·employee name· field.

1. Incremental: Refers to any Rolling List of Asks (RLoA) or in-quarter approved budget release not part of the annual plan. This headcount is released by Finance during the quarter and communicated directly by TALT in Pod Squad. Recruiters should ensure the correct ·req type· is selected in Greenhouse to inform the interlock sheet.

1. Intern: Refers to internship roles managed by the Emerging Talent team. These will not

appear in the interlock sheet, and the Emerging Talent team will work directly with FP&A for details.

1. Enter the GHP ID listed on the GitLab Hiring Plan. If you do not have a GHPID for any reason, FP&A will not approve your opening and you cannot post your position.

1. Fill in all other fields and continue on to the following pages.

The next page consists of attributes interviewers will be evaluating in their scorecards across the full interview process. These may not be known until after the Kick-off Session and may be skipped during the initial setup of the req.

The Interview Plan is where you'll craft the hiring process and scorecards for each step in the process. The interview plan may not be known until after the Kick-off Session and may be skipped during the initial setup of the REQ. This section, however, is not optional: It is important that all interview rounds are determined prior to opening a req. They should be formatted as Topic/Competency, Interviewer Name, Interview length (ie "Ruby Technical Interview, Harry Potter, 60 mins").

The Hiring Team is where you select who will be working on this opening and what access they should have.

- Scroll to the Who's responsible for this job? to assign the Hiring Managers, Recruiter(s), Coordinator(s) and Sourcer(s). Everyone who will be involved in interviewing may not be known until after the Kick-off Session.

- Ensure that only necessary team members have Hiring Manager access in the bottom section. Filter by Job Admin: Hiring Manager and ensure the only people with that level of access are Hiring Managers. Interviewers do not need Job Admin access and should be removed.

Set up Notifications where appropriate. You should make sure that you are always notified for internal candidates and referrals, but the rest is up to your preferences. Most recruiters prefer to use their own names, rather than Candidate's Recruiter, because it ensures they are notified even if the candidate is interviewing for multiple positions and therefore has a different default recruiter.

Scroll to the bottom of the page and click Request Approval.

In order to fully open a requisition in Greenhouse, you will need to complete the following approval path:

1. Finance
1. Department Lead

If you find that someone is delayed in responding to an approval request, you can click Send Reminder, send a Slack, or add a comment to the approvals page while tagging the approver. Ideally, the entire approval process completes within 24 hours.

Kick-Off Issue

1. The recruiter will open up a kick-off issue.

Kick-off & Finalize Greenhouse Setup (DRI: Recruiter)

The Recruiter will:

Complete the Kick-Off

1. Schedule a Kick-off Session or complete a-sync with the Hiring Team.
1. Prepare the job to be posted on the Careers Page.

Post the job internally

1. Create or update the Job Post under Job Setup, which will hold the opening description. Next to the name of the opening, click the pencil icon to edit the job post.

- Post To should always be Internal.
- Location is automatically set to Remote. If there is additional location information you'd like to add that should be included in the Job Name.
- Application Language should always be English.
- Pay transparency rules should always be N/A, because we do not post salary ranges on internal positions.

- Description copy the Job Description Template for Internal Job Posting. Work with your hiring manager to ensure alignment on the finalized job post.

1. If there are any links in the description, click on the link, then click the link icon in the text box toolbar, then change Target to New Window, then click Ok; this will ensure all links work properly.

1. For the Custom Application Questions, ensure the following questions are included:

- LinkedIn Profile
- Please let us know if there are any adjustments we can make to assist you during the hiring and interview process.
- Have you notified your current manager or PBP that you are applying to this role? Please note that internal candidates are required to speak with their current manager or PBP prior to application.

- What is the name of your current manager?

1. Settings

- Send Confirmation Email to Candidates: select the Internal Auto-Reply after Application from the drop-down list

- Application Confirmation Page: Default
- Uncheck Include EEOC Questions
- Uncheck Include 'Apply with SEEK' button

1. Click Save, then click the red button to publish the opening to our internal job board.

1. After publishing, announce on Slack in new-vacancies for team members to apply or send in referrals.

text

Slack message template:

New Job Alert: TITLE

Apply internally: LINK

Review how to make a referral: </handbook/hiring/referral-process/>

Post the job externally

1. Create or update the Job Post under Job Setup, which will hold the opening description. Next to the name of the opening, click the pencil icon to edit the job post.

- Post To should always be GitLab.

- Pay Transparency Rules will help you post salary ranges to your job description, if applicable. If your job will be posted to locations Remote, Americas, Remote, or Remote, US (any positions posted in the US), you should select Hiring in the USA. If this job will not be posted in the US, select N/A.

1. Copy the Job Description Template for External Job Posting and copy and paste it into the job description section. Work with your hiring manager to ensure alignment on the finalized job post.

1. Ensure the posted job title is aligned with the details outlined on Slide 10 in the Job Description Rebuild deck.

1. If there is already a job description listed, check to see if the External Job Description Template has been applied and that no salary information is in the job description.

1. If the Pay Transparency section is visible, add the CO/WA and CA/NY/NJ salary ranges that you see on the Approvals page.

1. Once your job description is finalized, please copy and add it to the Job Description Repository by creating a new Google Document, pasting your description there and titling it Job TitleDepartmentDate.

1. All external job posts should have resume required in the basic application questions.

1. All external job posts should ask the following custom application questions by default. If further custom questions are desired, discuss this during the kickoff call with your hiring manager:

- Please choose the country in which you are located.

- What's the name you'd prefer us to use throughout the interview process?

- Will you now or in the future require sponsorship for a visa to remain at your current location?

- Were you referred by a current GitLab team member? If so, please write their name below.

- Are you subject to any employment agreements and/or post-employment restrictions with your current employer or a past employer?

- It is important to us to create an accessible and inclusive hiring experience. Please let us know if there are any adjustments we can make to assist you during the hiring and interview process.

1. Ensure the confirmation box is checked and the email is set to the correct auto-reply.

1. Add EEOC questions only if your position will be posted in the US.

1. Uncheck Apply with SEEK and Publish to Indeed

Using job posting rules in Greenhouse

Setting up job posting rules when publishing a new job can save time later on by automatically removing candidates that are applying from countries in which we cannot hire them.

There are two fields that we can consider using job post rules to help manage applications: candidate location and candidate visa sponsorship needs.

The recommendation is to implement a rule on job postings that automatically rejects candidates who are applying from countries where we cannot actively hire.

To do this, the following steps should be taken:

1. In the custom application questions section of the job setup, add the question "Please choose the country in which you are located" and select the option to make this a required

question.

1. Navigate to the "Manage Rules" link in the "Job Posts" section of the job setup and choose to "Add a rule".
1. Design a rule so that when a candidate selects a country that we cannot hire them in then they are auto-rejected.
1. Choose "Country Hiring Restriction" as the rejection reason and choose to "send email" using the "Reject because we cannot hire in this country" template to be sent to the candidate.

Similarly, you can set up a custom rule to reject candidates based on visa requirements following the process above and applying rules to the question "Will you now or in the future require sponsorship for a visa to remain in your current location? (Please be aware that GitLab does not offer any form of Work Sponsorship.)"

If you are applying rules to reject candidates based on visa sponsorship needs it's important to consider whether there's a possibility that we may reject candidates with complex situations that we actually can hire. If there is any doubt, avoid using rules to reject candidates automatically based on visa sponsorship requirements.

Update the Scorecard

1. Update the Scorecard after the kick-off Session. The attributes are typically split up into various categories, such Requirements (copied from the job family), Responsibilities (copied from the job family), and Values (standard across all roles, see additional info in the next step).
 - These can be adjusted as needed, but every attribute listed should be a must-have and not a nice-to-have.
 - If you want to include nice-to-haves in the scorecard, please create a new category called Nice-to-haves and add any applicable attributes there, making sure that your entire interview team knows that if a candidate does not meet any of those attributes it is not a negative against them.
1. To create a new category, scroll to the bottom of the screen and s